

Jarrood Tran

Manager, AI & Factory Strategy · Tesla

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SUMMARY

Strategy & Operations and Technical Program Manager. I run AI adoption across Tesla Energy manufacturing (10k employees). Assess, build, ship, then hand off to a sustaining team. Built a forward-deployed applied AI team for custom buildouts, with factory strategy and NPI cost-down beside that work. Prior Waymo (Alphabet) Strategy & Operations, Apple iPhone India launch, Tesla 4680 special projects, Amazon fulfillment ops.

SELECTED RESULTS

- Tesla: AI enablement across 10,000 Energy Manufacturing employees; forward-deployed applied AI team (20+ tools, 1,000+ users, ~\$1.6M productivity)
- Tesla: led 12-month NPI cost-down, \$260M annualized; \$156M incremental annual profit on a \$23M / 50+ initiative book; Megapack 3.2×
- Tesla: \$550M projected tariff exposure mitigated
- Apple: India revenue \$2B to \$10B; units 4.3M to 16.9M; exports 6 to 40+ countries

EXPERIENCE

Tesla | Manager, AI & Factory Strategy | Aug 2023 – Present

10 direct reports. All production planning for the \$2.5B per quarter Megapack program. AI enablement for all of Energy Manufacturing (10k employees), which supports a ~\$4B per quarter Energy division.

- Lead AI enablement across Tesla Energy Manufacturing (10,000 employees). Assess, build, ship, then hand off to a sustaining team.
- Built a forward-deployed applied AI team for custom buildouts (20+ tools, 1,000+ active users, ~\$1.6M productivity). Hiring manager for that team.
- Lead a 12-month NPI cost-down across materials, labor, and supplier contracts: \$260M annualized cost-down, \$156M incremental annual profit, on a \$23M / 50+ initiative book. Megapack scale 3.2×
- Mitigated \$550M in projected tariff exposure by redesigning build plans and establishing FTZ / bonded-warehouse / product-changeover infrastructure.
- Own what we build, where we build it, and when we launch, plus regulatory and cost mitigation.

Waymo (Alphabet) | Strategy & Operations Manager | Oct 2022 – May 2023

- Set up annual planning, OKRs, resource plans, business reviews, and decision milestones so bottlenecks showed up without ad-hoc reporting.
- Returned to Tesla in Aug 2023 to lead AI and factory strategy for Energy Manufacturing.

Apple | Strategic Operations Program Manager | Jun 2021 – Jun 2022

- Set up the site, supplier, line, and demand plan for iPhone manufacturing in India from a standing start, under tight quality, regulatory, and timing requirements.
- The plan ran this ramp: revenue \$2B to \$10B, units 4.3M to 16.9M, exports from 6 to 40+ countries.

Tesla | Program Manager, Special Projects | Jun 2018 – Jun 2021

- Advanced Project Roadrunner from an early battery-cell pilot to a production-ready platform.
- Put in stage gates, readiness reviews, and supplier coordination, with launch owned across engineering, production, and supply chain.
- Sustained Model 3 / Model Y rates through demand surges and supply disruptions.
- Designed and launched a \$3.5M/month Warehouse on Wheels logistics platform protecting battery and drivetrain flow.

Amazon | Operations Area Manager | Mar 2017 – Apr 2018

- Led a team of 100+ associates in a high-volume fulfillment center.

SKILLS

Strategy & Operations | Technical Program Manager | AI enablement and adoption | Factory and operating strategy | Launch readiness | Capacity and cost economics | Manufacturing launches from a standing start

EDUCATION

University at Buffalo. B.S. Business Administration, Finance (Cum Laude)